MOTION SYSTEM · INTERACTIVE VALIDATION · FOR FOUNDER REVIEW

Calm continuity

The companion to Quiet confidence. Every demo below is live — click, press and toggle them. Motion here exists to explain where something came from and where it went, never to demonstrate that motion is possible.

Reduced motion

Drives every demo on this page. Toggle it and re-run any interaction to see the reduced-motion path, treated as a first-class state rather than an absence.

Current state: **full motion**. In production this is read from `prefers-reduced-motion`, not a manual switch.

MOTION HIERARCHY

Four levels, and nothing in between

The level is chosen by what the motion has to explain, not by how large the element is. Press each bar to run it.

1 · Instant

80ms. Press states, focus, selection. Perceived latency here is a defect, so motion is almost imperceptible.

Press me

scale 0.97 · ease-standard · no translate

2 · Fast

160ms. Hover, active nav, chips, tooltips, small dropdowns. Small state changes that must not draw attention to themselves.

Toggle state

colour only · ease-standard · distance 0

3 · Standard

240ms. Modals, sheets, drawers, accordions, toasts, content replacement. The default for anything with a spatial origin.

Reveal

translateY 16px + opacity · ease-enter

4 · Deliberate

380ms, the ceiling. Onboarding progression and major success states only. Short enough that nobody waits for it.

width, no bounce · ease-enter

MOTION TOKENS

Proposed values

Not implemented. Proposed for Development review alongside the typography tokens.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`--motion-instant`	80ms	Press, focus, selection
`--motion-fast`	160ms	Hover, chips, nav state, tooltip
`--motion-standard`	240ms	Modal, sheet, drawer, toast, content swap
`--motion-deliberate`	380ms	Onboarding progression, major success
`--ease-standard`	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)	State changes staying on screen
`--ease-enter`	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.8, 0.2, 1)	Elements arriving — decelerates into place
`--ease-exit`	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 1, 1)	Elements leaving — accelerates away, always faster than entry
`--motion-distance-xs`	2px	Hover lift, press settle
`--motion-distance-sm`	8px	Content replacement, error text entry, toast
`--motion-distance-md`	16px	Dropdown, popover, sheet handoff

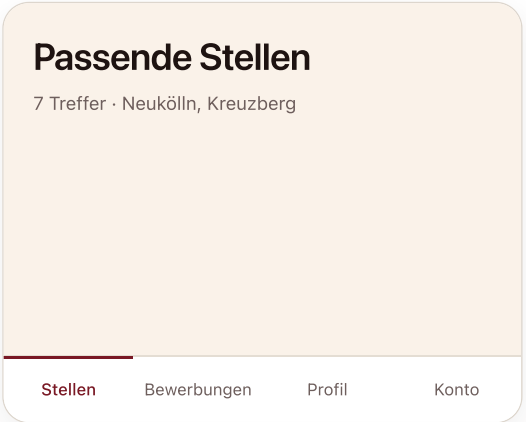
CONVENTION	RULE
Opacity	Always paired with a transform, never alone except in cross-fades. 0 → 1 over the full duration; never a partial fade to 0.8.
Scale	0.97 minimum on press, 1.0 resting. Never above 1.0 — nothing in Klinnova grows past its own size.
Springs	Not used. No overshoot anywhere in the system. An employment platform has nothing to be bouncy about.
Exit vs entry	Exits run at 0.75× the entry duration. Leaving should feel decisive, arriving should feel settled.
Emphasized easing	Not proposed. It exists to make one transition louder than the rest, which contradicts the principle. Omitted deliberately rather than defined and unused.
Reduced motion	Durations collapse to 100ms, all translate and scale to 0, opacity and colour transitions retained. Never a jump to 0ms — instant state changes read as glitches.
Properties	`transform` and `opacity` only for anything moving. `width`/`height` permitted only on progress bars and accordions, where there is no transform equivalent.

INTERACTIVE VALIDATION

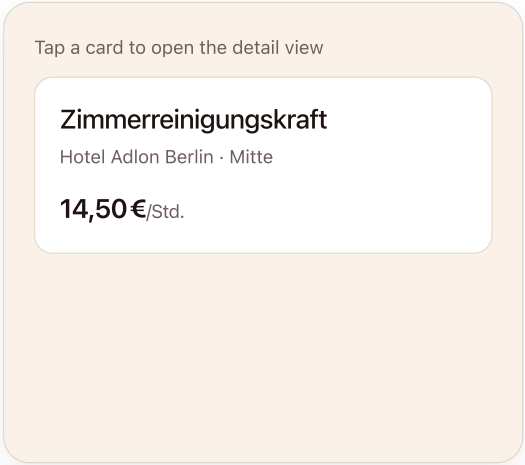
Twelve interactions, live

Each demo runs in the proposed typography system at 390px. The reduced-motion toggle above governs all of them.

1 · CANDIDATE BOTTOM NAVIGATION



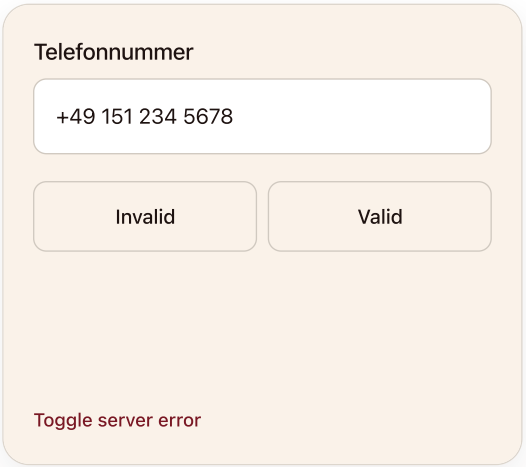
2–3 · VACANCY CARD, AND CARD → DETAIL



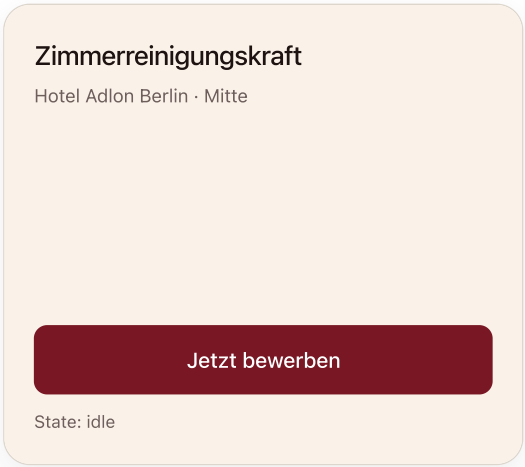
Purpose	Confirm the tap landed and replace content without losing place
Duration	160ms indicator and label, 240ms content
Easing	ease-standard on the indicator, ease-enter on content
Distance	Indicator slides its own width; content rises 8px
Behaviour	Weight 400→500 and colour shift accompany the indicator; no bounce, no float, no scale
Accessibility	`aria-current="page"` carries the state; three visual signals, none load-bearing alone
Reduced	Indicator and colour cross-fade in place, content translate drops to 0

Purpose	Card: confirm the touch. Transition: show the detail came from the card
Duration	160ms press, 240ms in, 180ms out
Easing	ease-standard press, ease-enter arriving, ease-exit leaving
Distance	Hover -2px, press scale 0.985, detail rises 8px as the list drops 8px
Behaviour	Press feedback matters more than hover — this audience is mobile-first, so hover is a desktop bonus, not the signal
Accessibility	Focus moves to the detail heading; the back control is reachable immediately, never gated on the animation
Reduced	Straight cross-fade at 100ms, no translate, no scale

4 · FORM VALIDATION, AND 10 · ERROR FEEDBACK



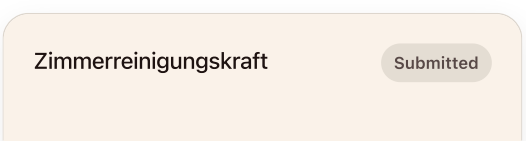
5 · APPLICATION SUBMISSION, AND 9 · SUCCESS



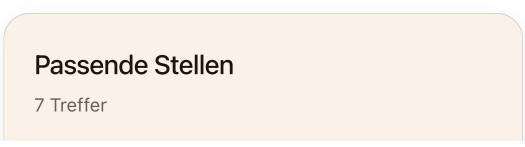
Purpose	Direct attention to what needs fixing without raising the stress of the moment
Duration	160ms field and message, 240ms banner. No entry delay — the message appears the instant it exists
Easing	ease-enter on the message, ease-standard on the border
Distance	Message rises 4px inside an animated height, so nothing below it jumps
Behaviour	No shake, no flash, no repetition. The border, the ring and the text change together, once
Accessibility	`aria-live="polite"` on the message, `aria-describedby` linking it to the field; focus moves to the first error on submit
Reduced	Height still animates to prevent a layout jump; the 4px rise is dropped

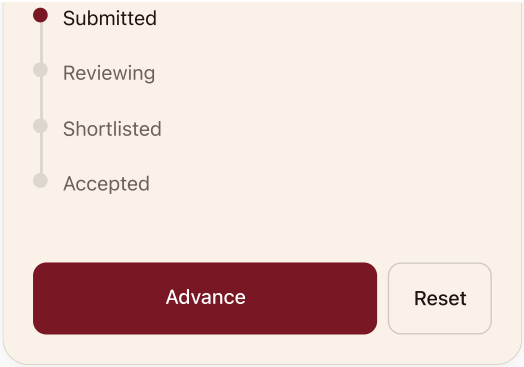
Purpose	Confirm the submission was received and is irreversible, without a celebration
Duration	160ms label cross-fade, 380ms success entry — the one deliberate-level moment on candidate surfaces
Easing	ease-enter throughout
Distance	Success panel rises 8px inside an animated height
Behaviour	Button stays in place and becomes its own progress indicator. No confetti, no bounce, no scale above 1.0
Accessibility	Button gets `aria-busy` while pending; the success panel is an `aria-live="polite"` region, so it is announced rather than only seen
Reduced	Panel fades in at 100ms with no rise; the progress fill still animates, as it conveys real state

6 · APPLICATION STATUS CHANGE

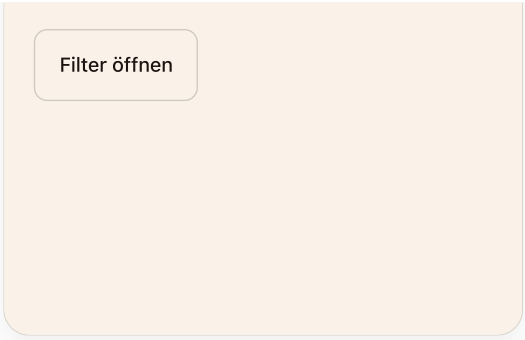


7 · MOBILE SHEET, DRAWER AND DIALOG



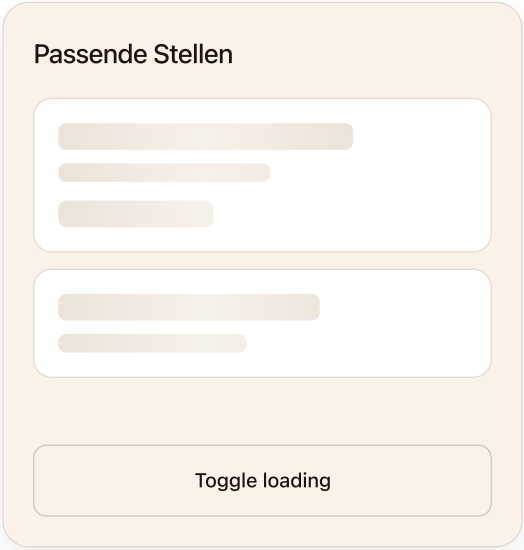


Purpose	Show that something moved, and exactly how far, without overstating it
Duration	380ms line growth, 160ms dot and pill
Easing	ease-enter on the line, ease-standard on colour
Distance	Line height only; the pill cross-fades with a 4px rise
Behaviour	Statuses shown are exactly the product's own. No new states invented, no scheduling or interview state introduced, no gamification
Accessibility	Timeline is an ordered list; the current step carries `aria-current="step"`; the pill announces politely. Motion never carries the state alone
Reduced	Line still grows — it is real information — but at 100ms; the pill rise is dropped

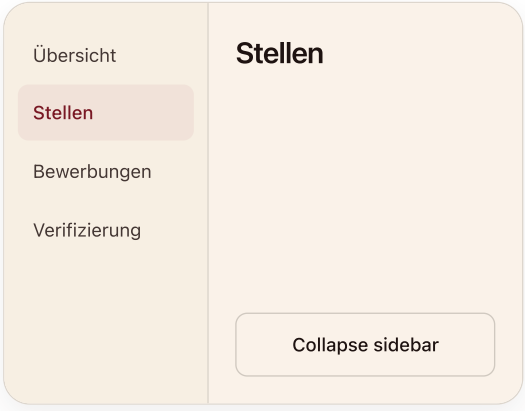


Purpose	Establish that the sheet is layered over the page and where it will return to
Duration	240ms in, 180ms out; backdrop matches the panel exactly
Easing	ease-enter in, ease-exit out
Distance	Sheet travels its own height from the bottom edge. Desktop dialogs instead rise 16px and fade; dropdowns and popovers rise 8px from their trigger edge
Behaviour	Entry direction always equals exit direction reversed — a sheet that came up goes back down, never sideways or by fading in place
Accessibility	Focus moves into the sheet on open and returns to the trigger on close; focus is trapped while open; Escape and backdrop tap both close it
Reduced	Sheet and backdrop cross-fade in place at 100ms with no travel

8 · LOADING



11 · EMPLOYER SIDEBAR



Purpose	Hold the shape of what is coming so nothing shifts when it lands
Duration	Skeleton fades out over 160ms, content in over 240ms, overlapping
Easing	ease-standard out, ease-enter in
Distance	Content rises 8px; skeletons never move
Behaviour	Skeletons are shape-matched to the real cards, so there is no reflow. Suppressed for the first 200ms of any request, so fast responses never flash a loader. Spinners only inside buttons, never page-level
Accessibility	Container is `aria-busy` while loading; the shimmer is decorative and hidden from assistive tech
Reduced	Shimmer stops entirely, skeletons become flat blocks, cross-fade shortens to 100ms

Purpose	Keep operational context while navigating; make the collapse legible rather than abrupt
Duration	160ms active state, 240ms collapse and content swap
Easing	ease-standard on state, ease-enter on width and content
Distance	Width only; content rises 8px. Labels fade before the width finishes, so text never squashes
Behaviour	Background, weight and colour together carry the active state — weight alone would be too quiet in a dense sidebar
Accessibility	`aria-current="page"` and `aria-expanded` on the collapse control; keyboard order is unaffected by the collapse
Reduced	Width still animates (it is layout, not decoration) at 100ms; the content rise is dropped

ROUTE TRANSITIONS

Recommendation: almost none

Tested against each named route pair. The finding is that page-level transitions add cost and almost no comprehension, because the destination is nearly always a different context rather than a zoomed-in view of the origin.

ROUTE	RECOMMENDATION	REASONING
Public → Register	None	A deliberate context change. An animation here only delays the form.
Login → Matches	None	The first thing a candidate wants is the list. Show it immediately.
Matches → Vacancy detail	**Yes** — 240ms, 8px	The only genuinely valuable one: the detail is the card expanded, so continuity explains where came from. Demo 2–3 above.
Vacancy → Apply	None, or an in-place sheet	If apply is a sheet rather than a route, the sheet motion already covers it. Preferred.
Apply → Confirmation	In-place state change	Should not be a route at all. Demo 5 shows the button becoming the confirmation.
Applications → Application detail	**Yes** — 240ms, 8px	Same list-to-detail relationship as vacancies. Consistency matters more than the effect.
Employer vacancies → Vacancy	None	Desktop, dense, keyboard-driven. Operators navigate this repeatedly and would feel any delay
Applicants → Applicant detail	None	Same reasoning. Reviewing forty applicants means forty transitions.

Rule. A route transition is justified only where the destination is a magnification of the origin. Everywhere else, render immediately. In no case does the user wait for an animation before interacting — the incoming view is interactive from its first frame, and the transition plays over it.

HOVER, PRESS, FOCUS

Press feedback carries the weight, not hover

Candidate surfaces are mobile-first, so hover is treated as a desktop enhancement and never as the primary signal. Every control below has a press state and a focus state; hover is additive.

CONTROL	HOVER, 160MS	PRESS, 80MS	FOCUS
Button	Fill darkens one step, -2px lift	Scale 0.985, lift releases	2px ring, offset by the radius
Card	-2px lift, shadow deepens	Scale 0.985, shadow flattens	2px ring on the whole card
Link	Underline, 4px offset	Colour darkens one step	2px ring, no underline change
Navigation	Background tint at 20%	Tint at 35%	2px ring inside the item bounds
Input	Border darkens slightly	Not applicable	Border to primary at 55% plus a 4px glow ring
Checkbox	Border darkens	Scale 0.94 on the box only	2px ring around the 44px hit area, not the 20px bo
Radio	Border darkens	Scale 0.94	As checkbox
Switch	Track tint deepens	Knob scales 0.94	2px ring around the track
Status control	Tint deepens 5%	Scale 0.98	2px ring; state never conveyed by motion alone

Focus is an accessibility state, never styling. It is identical whether reached by keyboard or programmatically, and it is never removed — including under reduced motion, where it simply appears without a transition.

REDUCED MOTION

A first-class state, not an absence

ASPECT	REDUCED-MOTION BEHAVIOUR
Duration	All levels collapse to 100ms. Never 0ms — an instant swap reads as a rendering glitch, not as calm.
Translation	Removed entirely. Sheets, dropdowns and content swaps cross-fade in place.
Scale	Removed. Press feedback becomes a background tint change instead.
Parallax and large spatial movement	Not present in the system at all, so nothing to remove.
Decorative entrance	Removed. Panels appear without a fade-rise.
Essential state feedback	Preserved: colour transitions, opacity, focus rings, button pending state, error appearance.
Real-information motion	Preserved: progress-bar fills and timeline line growth still animate, because the movement *is* the information. Shortened removed.
Height animations	Preserved, so error text and expanding panels still avoid a layout jump.
Shimmer and looping animation	Stopped. Skeletons become flat blocks.
Delays	Never introduced. Reduced motion must be at least as fast as full motion, never a penalty.

PERFORMANCE AND ACCESSIBILITY

Built for a modest Android device, not a MacBook

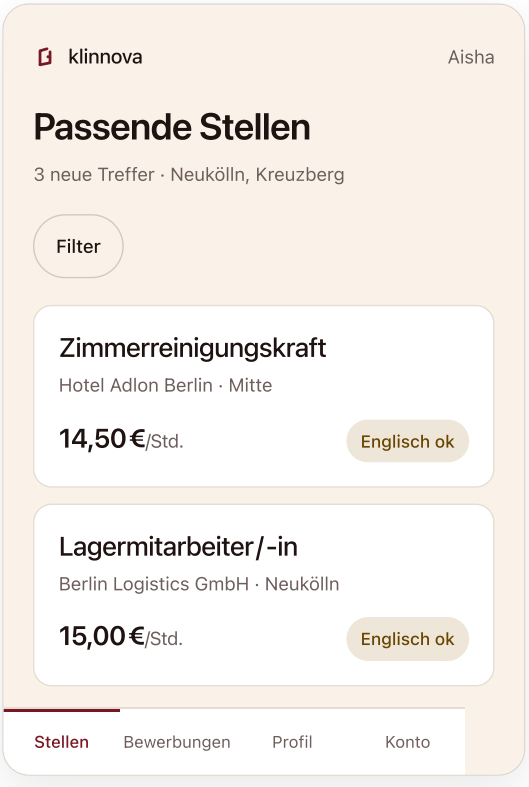
PERFORMANCE RULE	RATIONALE
`transform` and `opacity` only for movement	Compositor-only; no layout or paint work per frame
`width`/`height` permitted on progress bars and accordions	No transform equivalent. Both are small, isolated elements with no children to re-lay-out
No `box-shadow` animation on large surfaces	Repaints the whole element every frame. Shadows change on hover only, where a dropped frame is harmless
No `backdrop-filter` animation	Expensive on mid-range Android. Blur is static where used
No simultaneous animation of more than about six elements	Staggered entrances are capped at six items, then the rest appear
No continuous animation outside an active loading state	Nothing animates while idle, so nothing costs battery while idle
Shortest useful duration	240ms standard rather than 320–360ms — fewer frames to drop, and it feels more responsive on slow hardware

ACCESSIBILITY CHECK	RESULT
`prefers-reduced-motion`	Complete strategy above; treated as a state, not a fallbac
Keyboard navigation	Unaffected by any transition; tab order never depends on animation completing
Focus management	Moves into overlays on open, returns to the trigger on close, moves to the first error on failed submit
Screen-reader announcements	Status changes, validation errors and success confirmations are polite live regions
Information via animation alone	None. Every animated state also has text, colour and an ARIA attribute
Rapid flashing	None. No animation repeats, and nothing exceeds one cycle except the loading shimmer at 1.4s
Interaction blocking	None. No overlay or transition swallows input while playin
Task completion time	Longest single animation is 380ms and it never gates an action, so no measurable impact

UNIFIED VALIDATION

Quiet confidence and calm continuity, together

One candidate screen carrying both systems: the proposed type scale, weights and rhythm, with the proposed motion on every interaction. Press the card, open the sheet, submit, and toggle reduced motion above.



What the combination produces

Type carries the hierarchy at rest: 28px/600 title, 20px/500 card titles, 14px/400 metadata, nothing at 700. Motion carries the change: 160ms on anything small, 240ms on anything with a spatial origin, and no animation the reader has to wait for.

The two systems reinforce each other in one specific way worth naming. Because type no longer shouts, small motion becomes legible — a 2px lift and a colour shift are enough to register. In a heavier type system those cues would be lost, which is what pushes teams toward larger, slower, more theatrical animation. Restraint in one permits restraint in the other.

Light, smooth, precise, human, responsive, mature, trustworthy — and nothing on this screen exists to impress.

NON-GOALS, CONFIRMED ABSENT

What the system deliberately does not contain

Verified against this document: no parallax, no scroll-jacking, no page-transition sequences, no bouncing navigation, no springs or overshoot, no confetti, no continuous decorative animation, no animated backgrounds, no autoplay effects, no 3D, no cursor-following, and no animation that delays navigation. The only looping animation anywhere is the loading shimmer, which stops under reduced motion.

DECISIONS REQUIRED

Founder

- Adopt **Calm continuity** with the four-level hierarchy and the proposed durations. The judgement call is whether 240ms standard feels right, or a touch quick, for the brand.
- Accept **route transitions on list-to-detail only** — two places in the product, nowhere else. This is a deliberate no to something the brief left open.
- Confirm **no springs and no overshoot anywhere**, and no emphasized easing token. This is the main place this proposal is stricter than the reference it draws from.
- Confirm the **submission moment** (demo 5) is the right amount of positive feedback, since it is the emotional high point of the candidate experience and the one place restraint could read as coldness.

Development

- Can motion tokens live alongside the typography tokens as CSS custom properties that components consume, with `prefers-reduced-motion` overriding the duration values in one place rather than per component?
- Does the current routing support a list-to-detail transition without holding the incoming view non-interactive while it plays?
- Is there a shared mechanism for the 200ms loading-indicator suppression, or would each call site implement it separately?
- Are focus-management behaviours (trap, return, move-to-first-error) already centralised, or per component today?

Status

Design-only. Not handed to Development. Typography and motion are one proposal, and should be reviewed and approved together — the argument for each depends on the other. Nothing here changes product behaviour, palette, information architecture, workflow, status vocabulary or the logo direction. No new statuses have been introduced; the timeline in demo 6 uses only the product's existing states.

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